

# The Coastal Times

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COVER STORY

## AC Schnitzer Is Gone, and So Is the World That Made It

*It does not read like a simple business story, because it carries the weight of something more personal and more atmospheric, something that lives between culture and memory.*

Josh Ryner · BMW Blog

**W**hat makes the end of AC Schnitzer feel so heavy is not only what it was at the end, but what it once represented at its height, and how closely that world still brushes against my own relationship with BMW. It does not read like a simple business story, because it carries the weight of something more personal and more atmospheric, something that lives between culture and memory.

It recalls a very specific Germany, one shaped by autobahns that demanded composure at speed, by quiet industrial roads, and by workshops that did not advertise what they knew because they did not need to. For someone who lives with these cars, who walks up to one each day and understands it not as an object but as a presence, the loss feels closer, as if something that has always been part of the background has suddenly gone quiet.

There is a certain rhythm that comes with owning a BMW, a familiarity that builds over time without ever becoming routine. You approach the car, settle into it, and there is always that brief, almost unspoken moment where everything aligns, where the machine feels predictable in the best sense, not because it is simple, but because it is coherent. Even now, in modern cars shaped as much by software as by engineering, that feeling still exists, though it arrives more filtered than before. And maybe that is why the disappearance of a company like AC Schnitzer carries the weight it does, because it reminds you that there was a time when that feeling did not end at the factory gate, when the car in front of you was not the final expression of itself, but only the beginning of what it could become.

If there were a golden era for domestic German tuners, it was centered on the 1990s, though its roots stretch into the late 1980s and its influence lingers into the early 2000s. That period now feels almost impossibly balanced, as if every condition required for it to exist came together at

once. BMW was building cars of rare clarity and durability, machines that felt complete yet open, advanced yet understandable. Electronics had begun to shape the future, but they had not yet sealed the car away from those who wanted to work on it. Regulations existed, but they had not yet slowed development into something heavy and distant. Most importantly, there was still a strong belief among drivers that a car, no matter how refined, was not finished when it left the factory.

Out of that belief grew a distinctly German tuning culture, one that feels very far from the present. Germany did not produce tuners in the casual sense. It produced houses with identity and philosophy. ALPINA, Hartge, and AC Schnitzer approached BMW not as something to be altered for attention, but as something to be completed. The cars that emerged from their workshops did not reject their origins. They refined them. They carried the same DNA, but expressed with greater precision, greater intent, and a kind of quiet confidence that defined the era.

### AC Schnitzer: Engineering Over Spectacle

AC Schnitzer entered this world in 1987 in Aachen, drawing directly from the racing lineage of Schnitzer Motorsport, and from the beginning it carried a tone that set it apart. Its early work, including the ACS7 based on the E32 7 Series and the ACS3 Sport built on the E30 M3, made clear that this would be a company grounded in engineering rather than spectacle. The changes it introduced were rarely dramatic

on their own, yet together they transformed the car into something more resolved. Suspensions were recalibrated with care. Power was increased in a way that felt integrated rather than imposed. Aerodynamic elements appeared not as decoration, but as necessity, as if they had always belonged there.

Even its more ambitious creations held to that discipline. The V8 Roadster, placing a 4.4-liter V8 into the compact Z3, could have been chaotic in lesser hands, but here it remained controlled, almost composed, a clear extension of the same philosophy taken to its outer edge. Across decades, the company expanded its work, building thousands of components, refining BMWs across generations, and carrying its motorsport DNA into both road cars and competition, all while maintaining that balance between restraint and ambition that defined the best of German tuning culture.

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Josh Ryner

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#### The Cars That Made It Possible

That culture depended on the nature of the cars themselves. BMW platforms of the 1990s, from the E30 through the E39, offered a rare kind of openness. They were sophisticated enough to reward deep engineering, yet transparent enough to allow skilled people to understand and reshape them without obstruction. A tuner could work with the car, not against it, adjusting its character in ways that felt tangible and immediate. This created a relationship between manufacturer, tuner, and driver that was dynamic, almost conversational, with each contributing to the final identity of the machine.

It is this relationship that has quietly disappeared. Modern BMWs are, in every measurable sense, better cars. They are faster, safer, more capable, more refined. Yet they are also more closed, governed by software systems that resist intervention and by regulatory frameworks that stretch development into long, expensive cycles. By the time a tuner can bring a product to market, the moment has often passed. At the same time, BMW itself has absorbed much of what tuners once offered, providing performance packages and factory upgrades that narrow the space for independent interpretation.

#### A Different Kind of Ownership

For someone living with a modern BMW, this shift is felt not as a loss of quality, but as a change in relationship. The car arrives already resolved, already optimized, leaving little room to imagine what it could become. You experience it, you rely on it, you appreciate it, but you do not shape it in the same way. The sense of participation that once defined

ownership has given way to something more complete, but also more distant.

And that is why the end of AC Schnitzer feels like more than it should. It marks the fading of that open space between what a car is and what it could be. The golden era, with the 1990s at its center, depended on that space. It depended on cars that invited understanding, on engineers who had the freedom to reinterpret them, and on drivers who cared enough to see the difference. It created a quiet partnership, one that made owning a BMW feel like being part of an ongoing process rather than the end of one.

Now that partnership has thinned. The workshops have grown quiet. The cars have become more complete, more self-contained. And yet, standing next to a BMW today, even a modern one, there is still a trace of that older idea, something subtle but persistent. Beneath the software, beneath the refinement, there is still a machine with character, something that once invited people to take it apart, understand it, and make it their own.

That is the legacy AC Schnitzer leaves behind. Not only a history of cars, or a catalog of parts, but a way of seeing. It taught people to look at a BMW and understand that it was not the final word, that somewhere, in a quiet corner of Germany, someone might already be imagining a better version of it. Losing that idea feels like losing a part of the experience itself, a shift from a world where cars were shaped by many hands to one where they arrive already complete, asking less of you, and perhaps offering less in return.

First published by <https://www.bmwblog.com>

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## FEATURES

# How love for food made me participate in HackaNoodle?

Shakti Prasad SS · Grofers / Blinkit Lambda

Nihal and his friends at HackaNoodle 2022

What do you say when someone asks you why are you participating in a Hackathon? Saying that you've come to a hackathon for (free) food is not the ideal response, and more so to a CEO.

It was a Saturday morning, and I was in the Blinkit headquarters for a hackathon. Our team was working in one of the many glass meeting rooms when a serious-looking man in a black hoodie walked in and introduced himself, saying, "Hi, I'm Deepi".

Hearing this, one of my teammates said, "I got it". I, on the other hand, was super confused. I thought, maybe, I heard 'DP', which is an acronym for 'delivery partner' at Blinkit. I thought it was an internal joke I was unaware of. So, I just smiled and let it pass.

We began talking about the project, and after sharing and receiving a few suggestions, the man in black asked, "Yahan kya karne aaye ho?", which loosely translates to "what are you doing here?" I mentioned the first (honest) thing that came to my mind, "khaana khaane", translating to "to have food". And, we all had a hearty laugh.

Shortly after he left, my teammate, who was smiling earlier, nudged me and said it was the founder you were speaking with. It took me a good ten minutes to let that sink in.

Well, this is one of the many unusual things that happened last weekend at the headquarters. Let's start from the beginning.

A few weeks back, I was browsing through my LinkedIn feed and came across a post on HackaNoodle — a hackathon powered by Blinkit, with a special focus on women and the trans community. A big fan of hackathons/coding competitions in general, I quickly opened the link to learn more about it and, soon after, registered my name.

Since HackaNoodle was scheduled for November, we all had a few days to form our teams. We made a team of four — Ritika Patel, Palak Bansal, Akshit Sehgal, and me (Nihal Gupta). We started meeting online on Zoom calls to brainstorm what we wanted to build. With Diwali and festive preparations, the days went by quickly. Finally, the much-awaited weekend was here.

## The D-day

On November 5th, we all were standing outside a large building in Gurugram with a huge, yellow board on top reading Blinkit. It did not feel like anything big until we stepped in. But oh, how it all changed as soon as I entered the office. I could feel the energy all around me — hundreds of coders, a lot of hustle, and the crew welcoming each of us. However, one thing that (pleasantly) surprised me was

the number of women present there. We had 40+ teams, and all of them were led by women.

At the gates, we all got our goodie bags. Like a child, I took my bag aside, found the nearest table, sat there and started unpacking everything one by one. There was a cool black hoodie with my name written on it (which I wore then and there), a laptop pad, a water bottle, stickers (special thanks to the person who included cool stickers in the goodie bag, I love pasting stickers on my laptop), and a few munchies.

Once everyone settled in, the engineering team started briefing us on HackaNoodle — what it was, the theme, the judging criteria, and more. Here, we got to know how Zomato was founded because of a pizza craving Deepinder Goyal had 14 years back (now that I recall this, my answer does not sound dumb — food can take you places!). The story made us realise that we seldom remember how everything starts with a basic idea — be it a product or an organisation.

And we had 24 hours to think of that idea and build it from scratch.

And it began...

The marathon started, and all teams got a room each to eat, sleep, code, and repeat!

We hurried to discuss what we should build. Since the theme was "Build India's Next Unicorn", we had many horizons to explore. The challenge was to pick out the best.

In between our brainstorming sessions, the Blinkit team came for check-ins. They mentored and brainstormed with us and gave us real-time suggestions. It felt great to work with such brilliant minds.

Code, code, and more code

Once we finalised the idea, the rest of the day was packed with coding, caffeine, fixing bugs, and, yes... more caffeine.

We continuously tested our code, scratched our heads, and pulled our hair out when the code was not working. But in the end — we made it work!

Food scenes

What kept us working all those long hours without snapping at each other was food. We were in Blinkit's office, so no doubt the food arrangements had to be grand! Everything we needed — unlimited beverages, noodles, and munchies — was within an arm's distance. A great variety of dishes were served during every meal.

It felt like I was Charlie, and this was my chocolate factory.

The showtime

The next morning, we had to showcase what we had built. On one side were the top leaders of Zomato and Blinkit, and

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standard-article( title: [MINI Countryman Gets Adventure Packages, All-Terrain Tires for 2026], author: [Steven Paul], source-name: [BMW Blog], images: (), paragraphs: ( [It wasn't too long ago that MINI offered just one car. The Cooper is still the brand's most iconic offering, but the Countryman SUV arguably presents a more practical solution. This week, the brand introduced new port-installed options that make the not-quite-a-truck even more versatile. From all-terrain tires to roof racks and everything in between, MINI's offering a veritable wealth of customization on the new Countryman ALL4.], [Breaking Down MINI Countryman Port-Installed Options], [Arguably the biggest news here is MINI's addition of two 'option packages.' The first is the MINI Adventure Package, option code 0Z01, which bundles accessories that make the Countryman a bit more durable overall. It includes a roof rack base, all-weather floor mats, paint protection film, luggage mat, and loading sill protection mat. At \$1,100, it's probably a fairly good value for the paint protection film alone. However, the MINI Countryman gets its true off-road bona fides at the next level: the MINI Adventure Plus Package.], [MINI Countryman Adventure Package], [The MINI Adventure Plus Package sets you back quite a bit more: \$3,555. It also only adds one thing: new wheels and tires. Dig the new shoes: JCW Y-Spoke wheels in Frozen Midnight Grey, dubbed Style 945. More importantly, the new wheels come wrapped in all-terrain tires, General Grabber AT3s. The wheels alone cost \$2,465. So, you save exactly \$10 with the MINI Adventure Plus Package, compared to ordering the MINI Adventure Package and the wheels separately. What a deal!], [Of course, MINI also offers a selection of ancillary accessories to go along with these new port-installed packages. A ski/snowboard holder, bicycle roof rack, and roof box — the latter as a dealer-installed accessory — are all available, complementing the roof rack base included in the MINI Adventure Package. MINI also offers various mats and coverings as port-installed options, like all-weather floor mats. "Our accessories are the perfect addition to the most versatile models, for the adventurer looking to equip their vehicle to enjoy maximum fun of the great outdoors, any season of the year," said Vikash Joshi, Product Manager at MINI USA.], [Off-Roading Your EV? MINI Has You Covered, Apparently], [For those deeply curious, yes: you can order the all-terrain tires on the electric Countryman. MINI's press release: "This wheel and tire set (0ZFJ) is available on the MINI Countryman S ALL4 and MINI Countryman SE ALL4." It's the first time BMW or MINI have offered a full EV with off-road tires, which is perhaps an interesting anecdote as the rumors of a BMW M off-roader continue to crop up. Alongside it, whispers of a "BMW Rugged SUV" swirl — though less now than last summer. Either way, MINI's latest Countryman offerings show that someone in the organization is not forgetting about their customers who don't mind a bit of dirt. The gallery below shows everything you need to know about the new running gear.], [First published by <https://www.bmwblog.com>], ), insert-map: (:), word-count: 485, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false, )

standard-article( title: [Early contraceptive discontinuation and associated factors among married women initiating long-acting and short-acting contraceptives in humanitarian settings in Ethiopia: A retrospective cohort study], author: [Juliana Yartey Enos], source-name: [PLOS ONE Feed], images: (), paragraphs: ( [by Andamlak Gizaw Alamo, Agnes M. Kotoh, Emefa Judith Modey, Juliana Yartey Enos], [The sexual and reproductive health (SRH) service provision in conflict-affected populations has been continually overlooked. International and local relief organizations have begun to recognize the neglect of women's SRH needs; however, SRH services and humanitarian responses remain suboptimal. Contraceptive discontinuation is a significant public health issue with considerable impact on family planning (FP) programs, as well as on women's SRH and population growth. There is scarce information regarding the dynamics of contraceptive use in refugee areas. Evidence on contraceptive use dynamics is vital, especially now, as the global refugee crisis grows. Therefore, this study aimed to examine first-year contraceptive discontinuation and associated factors among married women initiating long-acting reversible contraceptives (LARC) and short-acting contraceptives (SAC) in selected refugee populations in Ethiopia.], [A retrospective cohort study was conducted among 551 married women in selected refugee populations in Ethiopia. After reviewing FP registries, all eligible women who initiated a contraceptive method 12–18 months before data collection were included in the study. Through computer-assisted face-to-face interviews, data on the socio-demographic, reproductive, and contraceptive use history of women were collected. Key characteristics of SAC acceptors and LARC acceptors were compared using chi-square statistics and t-tests. A multivariable Cox proportional hazards model identified the predictors of time to contraceptive discontinuation during the first year of use. In addition, adjusted hazard ratios (aHR), 95% CI, and P-values were calculated to determine the magnitude and precision of the association.], [The 12-month discontinuation rate for all contraceptive methods was 41.2% (95% CI: 37.2–45.4). The discontinuation rate for SAC (44.94%) was higher than LARC (32.32%) ( $P \leq 0.001$ ). The factors associated with 12-month discontinuation include method type (aHR = 1.50; 95% CI: 1.06–2.12), residence (aHR = 1.83; 95% CI: 1.24–2.70), husband occupation (aHR = 0.49; 95% CI: 0.29–0.84), length of stay in the refugee camp (aHR = 0.95; 95% CI: 0.92–0.99), and intention to use contraceptives in the future (aHR = 0.15; 95% CI: 0.11–0.21).], [A high rate of early contraceptive discontinuation was documented among refugee women, with a higher discontinuation rate among SAC acceptors. To improve contraceptive service provision and maintain continuous use of the methods initiated, targeted interventions, such as improved counselling and promotion of long-acting contraceptive methods, especially among urban refugee women, are crucial.], ), insert-map: (:), word-count: 375, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false, )

standard-article( title: [Cheap drones allowing war with volume], author: [Nathan Yau], source-name: [FlowingData], images: (), paragraphs: ( [Unmanned and relatively cheap drones that can be manufactured in high volume have changed airspace typically dominated by expensive jets and trained pilots. Reuters illustrates the shift that allowed less equipped countries to fight against larger ones .], [In just the first week of the conflict, Iran launched more than 1,000 drones and it is estimated to have the capacity to produce around 10,000 per month.], [The technology of war has evolved rapidly in recent years, a shift starkly illustrated by Ukraine's fight against Russia. What began as a conflict dominated by tanks and artillery has increasingly become a drone war. Outgunned in conventional armor and aircraft, Ukraine turned to inexpensive unmanned systems for reconnaissance and attack. Drones are estimated to account for about 70% of Russian casualties, enabling strikes to be carried out remotely and reducing the risk to pilots and aircrews.], [The build-up to show scale in this piece is quite something. Expensive and specialized aircraft fly across at first. Then a switch to hundreds of drones filling the sky shows the task of defending against high volume.], [Tags: cost , drones , Reuters , scale , war], ), insert-map: (:), word-count: 190, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false, )

section-label([Analysis]) standard-article( title: [The X-Peditions Workshops Site has Moved!], author: [David Hobby], source-name: [Strobist], images: (), paragraphs: ( [Two pieces of news, on the X-Peditions Hanoi photo workshops front:], [The first is that I retired from teaching as of November 2025. But X-Peditions is still going strong.], [The second piece of news is that their new instructor, as of Fall 2026, will be none other than Ibarionex Perello , of The Candid Frame podcast fame (among many other things.)], [He is perhaps the best person in the world to be stepping in as my successor. And I know you're going to enjoy working with him.], [Our Local producer in Hanoi is also remaining, which is also fantastic news. You could not be in better hands.], [The X-Peditions Hanoi Workshops page is now located here .], ), insert-map: (:), word-count: 117, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false, )

standard-article( title: [Underlying structure and measurement invariance by sex of the state trait anxiety inventory: A psychometric analysis in Ecuador], author: [Alberto Rodríguez-Lorenzana], source-name: [PLOS ONE Feed], images: (), paragraphs: ( [by Jose A. Rodas, Daniel Oleas, Guido Mascialino, José Alejandro Valdevila Figueira, Alberto Rodríguez-Lorenzana], [Anxiety is currently one of the most prevalent and investigated psychological symptoms requiring precise and reliable instruments for its assessment. The current study evaluates the psychometric properties of the State-Trait Anxiety Inventory (STAI) in an Ecuadorian sample, focusing on the factor structure and potential methodological artefacts, especially those introduced by reverse-scored items. Employing exploratory and confirmatory factor analyses (EFA and CFA), along with structural equation modelling (SEM), the research examines the presence of two distinct factors: genuine anxiety and a secondary factor related to reversed items. Findings indicate that the expected two-factor model fits the data more accurately than a unidimensional model. Notably, cross-loadings suggest the second factor may represent a substantive positive, anxiety-free state rather than solely a methodological effect. Additionally, multigroup CFA confirmed strict measurement invariance across sex, supporting the scale's utility for group comparisons. These results suggest that the STAI's total score represents a composite of anxiety and well-being. While the STAI remains a robust tool for evaluating anxiety in clinical contexts, researchers seeking pure measures of anxiety symptomatology should consider analysing the subscales separately.], ), insert-map: (:), word-count: 192, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false, )

standard-article( title: [Deals: Take Up to \$199 Off Apple's M1 MacBook Pro and MacBook Air at Best Buy and Amazon], author: [Mitchel Broussard], source-name: [MacRumors], images: (), paragraphs: ( [Best Buy and Amazon are both offering great deals on numerous models of the MacBook Pro and MacBook Air today, including a handful of record low deals on the latest Apple notebooks.], [Note: MacRumors is an affiliate partner with some of these vendors. When you click a link and make a purchase, we may receive a small payment, which helps us keep the site running.], [13-Inch M1 MacBook Air], [Starting with the 2020 M1 13-inch MacBook Air, you'll find the 256GB notebook for \$899.00 at Amazon and \$899.99 at Best Buy, down from \$999.00. Amazon stock has dwindled and will "ship soon," but Best Buy has plenty of stock in all three colors.], [Additionally, both retailers have the 512GB M1 MacBook Air at \$1,099.99 , down from \$1,249.00. While this is a record low price on the 512GB notebook, the 256GB model's discount is a second-best price.], [M1 MacBook Air, 256GB - \$899.99, down from \$999.00 at Best Buy / Amazon], [M1 MacBook Air, 512GB - \$1,099.99, down from \$1,249.00 at Best Buy / Amazon], [13-Inch M1 MacBook Pro], [For the newest MacBook Pro models, Best Buy and Amazon have lowest ever prices on the new 2020 M1 13-inch MacBook Pro. You can get the 256GB notebook for \$1,099.99 , down from \$1,299.00, in both Silver and Space Gray.], [For more storage, the 512GB M1 MacBook Pro is on sale for \$1,299.99 , down from \$1,499.00. This model is also available in both Silver and Space Gray at this

price.], [M1 MacBook Pro, 256GB - \$1,099.99, down from \$1,299.00 at Best Buy / Amazon], [M1 MacBook Pro, 512GB - \$1,299.99, down from \$1,499.00 at Best Buy / Amazon], [You can find even more discounts on other MacBooks by visiting our Best Deals guide for MacBook Pro and MacBook Air. In this guide we track the steepest discounts for the newest MacBook models every week, so be sure to bookmark it and check back often if you're shopping for a new Apple notebook.], [This article, "Deals: Take Up to \$199 Off Apple's M1 MacBook Pro and MacBook Air at Best Buy and Amazon" first appeared on MacRumors.com], [Discuss this article in our forums], ), insert-map: (:), word-count: 368, edited-for-length: false, debug-mode: false, )

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## BRIEFS

**New Scientist, New Scientist:** A duo of drugs that boosts our glymphatic system, which clears waste from our brain, also improves the removal of proteins associated with the onset of Alzheimer's disease

**New Scientist Space, New Scientist Space:** All five of the canonical nucleobases – the underpinnings of DNA, RNA and life on Earth – have been found in samples from the asteroid Ryugu

**New Scientist Space, New Scientist Space:** Black holes don't just bend space and time. They also expose where our understanding of reality begins to break. In this video, we explore supermassives, wormholes, gravastars and much more

**Jesse Steinmetz, Live Science:** A very long solar filament that had been snaking around the sun erupted with a flourish on Dec. 6, 2010.

**John J. Wiens** **Ellerie G. Blomenkamp** **Miles Corliss** **Xin Lia** **Department of Ecology and Evolutionary Biology, University of Arizona, Tucson, AZ 85721-0088** **Institute of Applied Biology, Shanxi Key Laboratory of Nucleic Acid Biopesticides, School of Life Sciences, Shanxi University, Taiyuan 030006, Shanxi, China, PNAS News:** Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences, Volume 123, Issue 12, March 2026. Significance The diversity of living organisms is increasingly threatened by human impacts, but still poorly known. Recently, there has been growing interest in protecting species that are especially divergent, including distinct genera and families (i.e., ...

**Harry Baker, Live Science:** Russia's Progress spacecraft have been used to ferry cargo to the ISS throughout the entirety of the space station's history. This photo shows Progress 45 docking with the ISS in 2011.

**Ze Zhong Jin** **Mu Qiao** **Siyang Fu** **Zi He Li** **Boxiong Guo** **Hongjiao Li** **Zhaoqi Leng** **Matthew R. Pinter** **Jakob Damgaard** **Benjamin L. Makepeace** **Silvia A. Mazzucconi** **Gavril Marius Berchi** **Fabio Cianferoni** **Dan A. Polhemus** **Kohei Watanabe** **Jun Nakajima** **Seraphine Esemu** **Chen Liu** **Beichen Zhang** **Huanhuan Yang** **Shujing Wang** **Huaijun Xue** **Wenjun Bu** **Zhen Yea** **Institute of Entomology, College of Life Sciences, Nankai University, Tianjin 300071, China** **Laboratory of Entomology, Wageningen University and Research, Wageningen 6700 AA, The Netherlands** **Institute of Environment, Florida International University, Miami, FL 33181** **Natural History Museum of Denmark, Zoological Museum, Copenhagen Ø 2100, Denmark** **Institute of Infection, Veterinary and Ecological Sciences, University of Liverpool, Liverpool, Merseyside L3 5RF, United Kingdom** **Laboratorio de Entomología, Instituto de Biodiversidad y Biología Experimental y Aplicada, Consejo Nacional de Investigaciones Científicas y Técnicas - Universidad de Buenos Aires, Departamento de Biodiversidad y Biología Experimental - Facultad de Ciencias Exactas y Naturales, Universidad de Buenos Aires, Buenos Aires C1428EHA, Argentina** **Department of Biology, Faculty of Chemistry, Biology, Geography, West University of Timișoara, Timișoara 300115, Romania** **Research Institute on Terrestrial Ecosystems, National Research Council of Italy, Sesto Fiorentino (Florence) I-50019, Italy** **"La Specola" Museum, Natural History Museum, University of Florence, Florence I-50125, Italy** **Department of Natural Sciences, Bishop Museum, Honolulu, HI 96734** **Ishikawa Insect Museum, Hakusan, Ishikawa 920-2113, Japan** **Fukuoka Institute of Health and Environmental Sciences, Dazaifu, Fukuoka 818-0135, Japan** **mLaboratory for Emerging Infectious Diseases, Faculty of Science, University of Buea, Buea PO Box 63, Cameroon** **nnSchool of Bioengineering, Qilu University of Technology (Shandong Academy of Sciences), Jinan, Shandong 250353, China, PNAS News:** Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences, Volume 123, Issue 12, March 2026. Significance Currently, our understanding of the macroevolutionary history of organisms that have colonized highly specialized two-phase habitats, such as air-water interfaces, remains rudimentary. Semiaquatic bugs (Insecta: Heteroptera: Gerromorpha), ...

**Edward P. Snelling, Nature News:** Nature, Published online: 25 March 2026; doi:10.1038/s41586-026-10291-3

New evidence suggests that diffusive oxygen transport through the tracheolar-muscle system is not the limiting factor on insect body size.

**Tory Shepherd, The Guardian Science/Space:** Study into how fertilisation could work in space finds sperm may get disorientated when trying to find an egg

Sperm in space are likely to get disoriented and lost while struggling to find their way to an egg, a new study has found.

When exposed to microgravity in experiments, sperm tumble around like an untethered astronaut, according to Adelaide University researchers.

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**New Scientist Space, New Scientist Space:** An ultrastable laser could enable extremely precise timing and navigation on the moon, and the cold, dark craters near the lunar poles would be the ideal location for it

**New Scientist Space, New Scientist Space:** Looking for molecular evidence of life on other worlds is tricky, but a test based on the reactivity of carbon compounds could be a useful indicator

**Hoyt Patrick Taylor IV, Nature News:** Nature, Published online: 25 March 2026; doi:10.1038/s41586-026-10219-x

fMRI data from individuals of a wide range of ages (from a few days to 100 years old) are used to map the key organizational axes of functional connectivity in the human cortex throughout the lifespan.

**Pepijn G. Moerman** **Cheng-Hung Chou** **Thomas E. Videbæk** **W. Benjamin Rogers** **Rebecca Schulman** **Department of Chemical and Biomolecular Engineering, Johns Hopkins University, Baltimore, MD 21218** **Department of Chemical Engineering and Chemistry, Eindhoven University of Technology, Eindhoven 5612 AE, The Netherlands** **cMartin A. Fisher School of Physics, Brandeis University, Waltham, MA 02453** **dDepartment of Chemistry and Computer Science, Johns Hopkins University, Baltimore, MD 21218, PNAS News:** Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences, Volume 123, Issue 12, March 2026. Significance Self-assembly of colloidal building blocks is a promising method, inspired by nature, to build materials with varied structural features from which the material may derive interesting optical and mechanical properties. However, features on ...

**New Scientist Space, New Scientist Space:** Spacecraft orbiting the Red Planet have helped researchers map out an ancient coastline that surrounded a large ocean billions of years ago



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# The Coastal Times

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*Curated and composed automatically.*